PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Land Rover Range Rover L322

2002–2012 · L322

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Demand timing-chain paperwork**
  On 2003–2005 BMW-engined trucks, look for receipts for chains and guides, or budget for them. The nylon guides go brittle and break, and owners report failures clustering around 130,000–170,000 miles. On 2010–2012 5.0s, check for tensioner and guide updates. Listen for a rattle on a cold start.
- [ ] **Cycle the air suspension through every height**
  The compressor should be barely audible. Grinding means it's on its way out. Watch for slow rises, a lean, or warnings. On 2003–05 trucks, corroded or seized height sensors can stop the truck adjusting without leaving any fault codes.
- [ ] **Test low range and the range-change motor**
  Select low and back again with the truck stationary. A range-change motor that has seized from lack of use can cost about £1,000 to fix. Make sure Hill Descent Control works too.
- [ ] **Treat 'sealed for life' gearboxes as unsealed**
  Hesitant shifts or warning lights point to gearbox trouble. Ask whether the fluid and filter have ever been changed. Atlantic British recommends a service every 60,000 miles on later ZF six-speeds, including the leak-prone valve-body sleeve. A rebuild costs about £2,000 in the UK.
- [ ] **Listen at full lock**
  Knocking at low speed on full lock can mean a front differential problem, and many were recalled. Clonks over bumps from the rear point to perished hub bushes.
- [ ] **Read the codes before and after the drive**
  A pre-purchase diagnostic scan is cheap insurance. Read the codes before and after a long test drive, because sellers can clear faults just before you arrive. Check that every warning light comes on with the ignition and then goes out.
- [ ] **Hunt for water and oil**
  Check for water in the rear fuse box and under the carpets. Check the M62 for valve-cover and other oil leaks, and look for white coolant streaks around the expansion tank. Expansion tanks fail.
- [ ] **Check the brakes and wheels**
  L322s are hard on brakes; expect discs and pads about every 30,000 miles. Avoid 22-inch wheels with low-profile tyres, which ride badly and pinch-puncture easily.

YEARS TO KNOW

2003–05	BEWARE	BMW-engined trucks. The nylon timing-chain guides go brittle, so buy only with receipts or plan to replace them. The 2003–05 front-diff coupling recall also applies.
2007	SWEET SPOT	Terrain Response, a locking centre diff, an electronic rear diff (standard on Supercharged), Brembo brakes and an electronic handbrake; TDV8 replaces the Td6 outside the US, and the switchblade key arrives mid-year. Guides and owners rate 2007–09 Jaguar-engined trucks the most dependable L322s

2010	BEWARE	Facelift: 5.0 V8 (375 PS) and 5.0 supercharged (510 PS), LED-accented headlights and a 12-in TFT instrument panel. The 5.0's timing-chain tensioners wear; buy a 2010–12 only with proof of updated parts

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- ☐ **Front differential coupling / propshaft spline wear**
  2003–2005 · NHTSA 08V-635
- ☐ **Transmission parking pawl guide plate**
  2006 · NHTSA 05V-502
- ☐ **Front brake hose rupture**
  2006–2012 · NHTSA 15V-039
- ☐ **Takata passenger airbag inflator (Zone A)**
  2007–2011 · NHTSA 16V-374
- ☐ **Takata passenger airbag inflator (expansion)**
  2007–2012 · NHTSA 17V-015
- ☐ **Occupant classification system**
  2010 · NHTSA 09V-467
- ☐ **Windshield installation**
  2012 · NHTSA 12V-485

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Engine era**
  2003–05 US trucks have BMW's M62 4.4. For 2006–09 it's Jaguar's AJ-V8, as a 4.4 or a 4.2 supercharged. 2010–12 trucks have the 5.0 or 5.0 supercharged. The diesels (Td6, 3.6 TDV8, 4.4 TDV8) were never sold in the US.
- ☐ **4×4 hardware**
  Before 2007 the truck has a Torsen centre diff and no Terrain Response. From 2007 it has Terrain Response, a locking centre diff and an electronic rear diff (standard on Supercharged, optional on others).
- ☐ **2010 facelift tells**
  LED-accented bi-xenon headlights, LED tail lights with a three-bar design, fog lights moved lower in the bumper, and a 12-in TFT virtual instrument panel instead of analogue gauges.
- ☐ **Key**
  Around January 2007 production the BMW-style key gave way to Land Rover's sealed 'switchblade' key, which recharges from a coil in the ignition switch.
- ☐ **Holland & Holland**
  Not an official Land Rover limited edition. Overfinch built them from standard trucks, on the 4.4 TDV8 or 5.0 supercharged, with a gun box, a drinks cabinet and the 'Aero 3' body kit.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/range-rover/l322/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks